

FABRICATED DOCUMENT — TEST FIXTURE

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Aldergrove Resilience Fund

Community Climate Adaptation Grants — Request for Proposals (RFP)

Solicitation number: ARF-CCA-2026-03 **Release date:** March 2, 2026 **Program area:** Community Climate Adaptation

Overview

The Aldergrove Resilience Fund ("the Fund") is a private grantmaking foundation supporting applied, community-partnered research on climate adaptation in small and mid-sized U.S. municipalities. Through the Community Climate Adaptation Grants program, the Fund supports one- to two-year projects that pair academic or nonprofit research capacity with municipal government partners to produce adaptation tools that a resource-constrained local government can actually adopt.

This RFP solicits proposals for the 2026 grant cycle. Approximately six awards will be made.

Program Background and Priority Areas

The Fund was established in 2019 to address a gap its founders observed between climate-adaptation research produced at research-intensive universities and the operational capacity of the small planning offices expected to use it. Most published adaptation tools assume a level of GIS staffing, budget, and technical support that a mid-sized municipality (population under 250,000) rarely has.

For the 2026 cycle, the Fund prioritizes proposals addressing one or more of the following:

- **Urban and extreme heat.** Tools, sensor networks, or planning methods that help municipal staff identify and respond to neighborhood-scale heat exposure, particularly where existing vulnerability indices are too coarse (e.g., census-tract resolution) to guide site-specific interventions such as tree planting, cool-roof incentives, or cooling-center placement.
- **Coastal and riverine flooding.** Adaptation planning tools for municipalities facing recurrent nuisance flooding or long-term sea-level exposure, with an emphasis on tools usable without specialized hydrological modeling staff.
- **Water scarcity and drought.** Municipal water-system resilience planning in regions facing recurring or structural water stress.

Proposals must identify at least one committed municipal government partner with a population under 250,000, and should explain concretely how the proposed method or tool is designed for adoption by a planning office with limited technical staff — the Fund's reviewers will weigh this "small-office usability"

test heavily regardless of topic area.

Eligibility Criteria

Eligible applicants are:

- U.S. institutions of higher education (public or private nonprofit);
- U.S. 501(c)(3) nonprofit organizations; or
- U.S. municipal or county government agencies applying directly.

The Principal Investigator must hold a faculty, research-staff, or equivalent professional appointment at the applicant institution. Independent researchers without an institutional affiliation are not eligible to apply as PI, though they may participate as project personnel under an eligible applicant.

Applicants must identify at least one committed municipal government partner (population under 250,000) that has agreed to participate in the project as a study site or pilot deployment location. Projects proposing work in a single very large city (population over 250,000) are not eligible for this program; the Fund's separate Metro Adaptation Grants program (solicitation ARF-MAG) covers that context.

Award Size and Period

- **Maximum award:** \$75,000 total costs (direct and indirect combined) per project.
- **Project period:** 12 to 24 months.
- **Anticipated number of awards:** approximately six, subject to the quality of the applicant pool.

Budgets exceeding the \$75,000 ceiling will not be considered for funding under this solicitation regardless of scientific merit; applicants with larger project scopes should consider phasing the work or applying to the Fund's Metro Adaptation Grants program, which carries a higher ceiling.

Format Requirements

- Narrative sections (Abstract through Approach, inclusive) must not exceed **8 pages**, excluding budget, budget justification, references cited, and required attachments.
- 11-point font, Times New Roman, Garamond, or equivalent serif face.
- 1-inch margins on all sides.
- Single line spacing within paragraphs; one blank line between sections.
- References cited in any consistent numbered format (the Fund does not mandate a specific citation style).
- Submit as a single PDF file. Do not submit as multiple separate files or as a compressed archive.

Required Proposal Sections

Every proposal narrative must include the following sections, in this order, using clearly labeled headings:

1. Title
2. PI and Institutional Affiliation
3. Abstract

4. Specific Aims
5. Background and Significance
6. Approach and Methods
7. **Data Management Plan** — describing what data the project will collect, how it will be stored and backed up during the project period, and what portion (if any) will be made publicly available after the award period ends, consistent with the Fund's open-data expectations described below.
8. Budget and Budget Justification
9. References Cited

Proposals missing any of the above sections will be returned to the applicant without review.

Required Attachments

In addition to the narrative, applicants must submit the following as separate attachments:

- **Letters of Institutional Commitment.** A signed letter from each named municipal or community partner confirming its commitment to participate in the project (e.g., site access, data sharing, staff time). Proposals naming a municipal partner without an accompanying commitment letter from that partner will be considered incomplete.
- **Budget Justification Narrative.** A one-page narrative explaining each budget line item. A budget table alone does not satisfy this requirement.
- **Biosketch or CV for the PI.** No more than two pages, NIH-style or equivalent format acceptable.
- **Current and Pending Support statement** for the PI, listing all other active or pending external funding.

Incomplete applications — missing any required attachment — will not advance to panel review.

Prohibited Content

The following are not permitted anywhere in the proposal:

- Content generated primarily by an AI writing tool and presented as the applicant's own analysis or original prose. Applicants may disclose and describe AI-assisted drafting in a brief methodological note, but undisclosed AI-generated narrative is grounds for disqualification.
- Fabricated, unverifiable, or non-existent citations. All cited sources must be independently verifiable by Fund staff.
- Preliminary results presented as though independently peer-reviewed or published, when they have not been.
- Budget line items for indirect costs exceeding 15% of direct costs.
- Lobbying activities or attempts to influence pending legislation, per the Fund's private-foundation tax status.

Evaluation Process

Complete, eligible applications advance to a panel of external reviewers with relevant subject-matter expertise. Panel scores are combined with staff review of budget and compliance to produce funding recommendations to the Fund's board. See the companion document, **Aldergrove Resilience Fund:**

Evaluation Criteria and Scoring Rubric, for the full weighted scoring framework used by panelists.

Applicants should expect a decision within approximately 14 weeks of the submission deadline.

Submission Deadline and Instructions

- **Deadline:** All materials must be received no later than **11:59 PM Eastern Time on September 15, 2026**. Late submissions will not be accepted regardless of cause.
- Submit all materials as a single PDF through the Fund's online application portal at **apply.aldergroveresiliencefund.example**.
- Do not email proposal materials directly to Fund staff; email submissions will not be reviewed.
- Applicants will receive an automated confirmation upon successful portal submission. If no confirmation is received within 24 hours, contact Fund staff using the information below before the deadline.

Contact Information

Questions about eligibility, priority areas, or the application portal should be directed to:

Dr. Priya Anand-Solberg Senior Program Officer, Community Climate Adaptation Aldergrove Resilience Fund 1140 Cumberland Terrace, Suite 300 Aldergrove, VA 22201

Email: panand-solberg@aldergroveresiliencefund.example Phone: (571) 555-0148

Applicants are encouraged to submit questions at least two weeks before the deadline. The Fund does not offer pre-submission review of draft proposals.